

Due to the ubiquity of the Internet, a network infrastructure is now in place for the 'Internet of Things' — a new world of tens of billions of connected devices. The majority of those devices are expected to be hubs and sensor nodes, collecting data and transmitting it from machine to machine (M2M). Application examples include aerospace and defence communication infrastructure, industrial automation, smart meters, fleet management, device monitoring, medical and patient monitoring, and situational awareness.

With cyber threats becoming more sophisticated, and more critical infrastructure being controlled by these embedded devices, security protection will be required on each device rather than just relying on the network protection that is in place today.

NOOBS to make your Raspberry Pi set-up easier

Raspberry Pi, the hackable minicomputer that supports open source software, comes without any pre-installed operating system and the buyer needs an SD card for storage. Is this all sounding a little too geeky to you?

Well, now there is a new tool for the actual 'noobs' who want to know of easier ways to set up a Raspberry Pi. We said 'noobs' rather than newbies because the tool itself is called NOOBS, an acronym for 'New Out Of Box Software'. As the name suggests, this tool is aimed at the newbie audience.

You might not need NOOBS if you're a techie who is a source code compiler. But in case you just want Raspberry Pi to plug in the SD card and play games, watch videos or surf the Internet, NOOBS can come to your aid.

Wandboard's Android, Linux minicomputer now in quad-core

Here comes another tiny computer (a.k.a. a developer board) called Wandboard. It looks pretty much like Raspberry Pi, but the starting price is much higher and so is the power of the device.

While Raspberry Pi has an ARM11 single-core processor, the Wandboard comes with a superfast Freescale i.MX6 ARM Cortex-A9 processor. Also, gone are the days of single and dual-core versions; Wandboard offers a quad-core model. Additionally, it has 2 GB of RAM, 2 microSD card slots, HDMI and USB ports, and Gigabit Ethernet as well as built-in Wi-Fi and Bluetooth.

The quad core Wandboard is priced at \$129, and the single- and dual-core models are retailing at \$79 and \$99, respectively.

Besides having more processor cores than its low-cost counterparts, the tiny computer also has greater memory, and it can easily be called the only model with a SATA connector to help you attach a hard drive or solid state disk.

Tizen Linux gets Unity mobile platform support

We can certainly expect Tizen, the latest Linux-based mobile platform, to offer most of the features that are available on other existing platforms. The latest platform being developed by majors like Samsung and Intel take its source code from Linux and, reportedly, will be launched on high-end devices by the end of this year.

But in an exciting new development, Unity has announced that it is working on a module that will add support to the Tizen OS. The new module for Tizen will enable developers to create and publish games for smartphones and tablets, powered by the operating system.



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